

MAKONNEN MULIMA

Front-end AI Engineering Intern | AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner

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Front-end AI Engineering Intern building production-grade, accessible interfaces where AI is integrated meaningfully rather than bolted on. AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner. Focused on work that holds up under real scrutiny — accessible, tested, and genuinely functional, not just demo-ready.

EXPERIENCE

Front-end AI Engineer Intern — FlyRank AI, Remote

June 2026 –
Present

- Built and shipped an AI-powered chat feature (Next.js, React, TypeScript, Vercel AI SDK) with tool-calling, full keyboard support, and screen-reader-announced streaming responses
- Led a full accessibility and performance audit, raising Lighthouse accessibility to 100/100 and resolving WCAG 2.1 AA contrast failures across the codebase; mobile performance improved 83→88
- Built a drag-and-drop 3D model viewer (React Three Fiber) with automated asset compression (3.77MB → 442KB) and reduced-motion/low-bandwidth fallbacks
- Added input-based abuse protection to the AI chat endpoint and an automated test suite (Vitest, Playwright) wired into continuous integration

Freelancer — Self-employed

June 2025 – June
2026

- Provided technical support for computer hardware issues and built custom gaming PCs for clients, diagnosing hardware faults and advising on component compatibility and performance

PROJECTS

Personal Portfolio — Next.js, React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS

[makonnen.is-a.de
v](https://makonnen.is-a.dev)

- Designed, built, and maintain a production personal site featuring an AI chat interface, a 3D model viewer, and case studies of AWS and front-end work
- Replaced default demo assets with custom-built assets, including a self-modeled logo compressed 97% (1.36MB → 35KB) with no fidelity loss

Accessible Components Playground — React, TypeScript

[github.com/NBA-Makonne
n](https://github.com/NBA-Makonnen)

- Built ARIA-compliant Modal, Tabs, and Disclosure components from scratch and benchmarked them against shadcn/ui
- Found and fixed a real focus-management bug, verified with a regression test

SKILLS

Frontend: React, Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Git, Web Accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA)

Cloud: AWS Cloud Practitioner (Certified), AWS Cloud Best Practices, Building Infrastructure on AWS

AI & Prompting: Prompt Engineering, Responsible AI Use

EDUCATION

ALX Africa — Certificate Program, Johannesburg

Oct 2023 – Jan 2025

Wordsworth High School — National Senior Certificate, Benoni

Jan 2017 – Dec 2021

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner • Full Stack Developer(FNB App Academy)